



SMS Alert System

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We receive many SMS alerts every day. These are automated messages that are broadcast to a list of mobile numbers. Ever wondered how the system works? This article can help you build your own SMS alert system in no time and monitor it as well.

If you check the messages in your mobile phone, you will see that these marketing SMSes come from

unknown numbers. Companies use services from Cloud communication platforms and send you messages that are computer-generated via the Internet. Advantage of using such a platform is evident—messages can be broadcast to any number of people at predefined times, without human intervention.

In this article we build a similar system using an interesting Python package that I recently discovered.

It is called Twilio Python Helper Library. Twilio (www.twilio.com) is a Cloud communication platform that provides APIs to build apps that can communicate via text messaging. We use this package to build our SMS alert system.

We use another API from OpenWeatherMap (<http://openweathermap.org>) and read current humidity levels at a specific location. This software currently monitors for Delhi region, but you can change it for your location. If the read humidity exceeds 70 per cent, it sends a message 'Humidity exceeds the set level' to your mobile. Else, it sends 'Humidity below set level' to your mobile at desired intervals. Messages are sent using Twilio API. I have added humidity-monitoring feature to give you an example. You can monitor whatever you want.

The software is written in Python programming language and tested on a Windows 10 OS based computer.

Download and install Python 2.7.11

As the software is built using Python programming language, install it on your computer before starting to write any code. Use Python 2.7.11

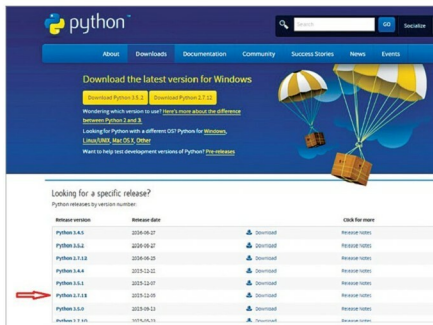


Fig. 1: Download Python

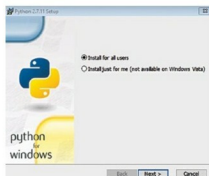


Fig. 2: Install for all users

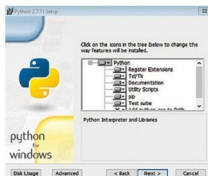


Fig. 3: Select location for installing Python

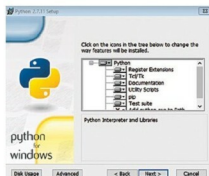


Fig. 4: Default selection